

Chand Baori

A masterpiece of ancient Indian architecture and one of the world's largest stepwells

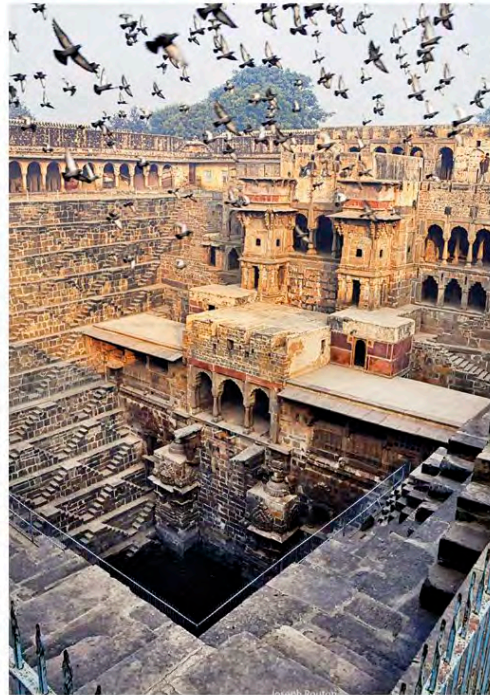


Chand Baori is a stepwell—a well or pond in which the water is accessed by steps—in the village of Abhaneri, Rajasthan. Constructed between the 8th and 9th centuries CE, it was designed not simply to collect and conserve water from the water table deep underground, but also—given its proximity to the picturesque 7th–8th-century Harshat Mata Temple—as an object of aesthetic beauty, a meeting space for the local community (including the royal family), and a shelter from the heat of the day.

Design and precision

Considered an artistic and architectural masterpiece, Chand Baori is one of the world's largest stepwells: it has 13 stories and 3,500 mazelike steps, which become narrower as they descend below ground level. It is also notable for its extraordinary geometric precision and breathtaking symmetry. Magnificent stone sculptures and friezes adorn the building's various halls and columns.

Chand Baori **featured** in the film *The Dark Knight Rises*



◁ VIEW OF THE INTERIOR

Hailed as a masterpiece of Rajasthani art and architecture, Chand Baori has hundreds of steps on three of its sides; on its fourth side, seen here, is a pavilion with arches, balconies, and pillars, some of which have intricate carvings.

▽ THE STAIRWAYS

An ingenious system of multileveled, intersecting steps is built into the sides of the walls at Chand Baori, providing access to what was once a subterranean water supply.

